

Constitution of the Institute of Minecraft Studies Publishing Department

I Introduction

1. § The Publishing Department upholds the academic and journalistic wings of the Institute of Minecraft Studies. The goal of the Department is to publish articles dealing with Minecraft studies, as well as to keep people informed regarding current affairs within the scope of the Institute.
2. § This Constitution outlines the purpose, values, fundamental rules, and structure of the Department. Every member shall strive to further the goals of the Department and of the Institute.

II Values

3. § Members shall treat each other with respect, display basic empathy, and be understanding of mistakes. These fundamentals are essential for ideas to be openly produced and refined without fear of judgment. The Department seeks to create and maintain a lasting, self-sustaining process of theory, experimentation, and content creation.
4. § Honesty and transparency are crucial pillars of the democratic and free nature of the Department. Scientific work shall be conducted with academic integrity, and news articles shall be in line with journalistic standards.

III Subdepartments

5. § The Department is structured as follows:

- (1) The Journal Subdepartment is responsible for reviewing, editing, and publishing the Journal, consisting of articles examining various aspects of Minecraft studies.
- (2) The Press Subdepartment is responsible for the writing, reviewing, editing, and regular publishing of journalism, investigation, and opinion.

IV Roles

6. § Staff roles within the Department are defined as follows:

- (1) The editor-in-chief
 - (i) guides, supervises, and represents the Department;
 - (ii) ensures smooth cooperation with other departments;
 - (iii) publishes a monthly transparency report; and
 - (iv) upholds the fundamental values of the Department and of the Institute.
- (2) Subdepartment coordinators are responsible for
 - (i) the day-to-day operations of their subdepartments and
 - (ii) ensuring smooth cooperation between participants, IMS members, and other subdepartments.
- (3) Columnists write opinion articles, op-eds, and reviews.
- (4) Reporters conduct journalism and investigations.
- (5) Editors perform editorial work on articles.

V Hiring of staff

7. § In accordance with the Institute’s equality principle, any member who wishes to do so may participate in the Institute’s work. As such, anyone may apply to participate in the Department. During a three-month mentoring period, trainees are assisted by an experienced member.

8. § After the mentoring phase, the editor-in-chief decides on the member’s admission. Acceptance may only be declined in cases of substantial concerns over behaviour, contrary to the Institution’s values. A detailed justification is provided to the member in case of rejection, which may be appealed to the Department.

VI Election of coordinators and editor-in-chief

9. § Subdepartment coordinators are elected by Department members for three-month terms through secret voting. These elections are organized by the editor-in-chief and last at least 48 hours. Any Department member may stand in these elections. Subdepartment coordinators are distinct people and cannot be the editor-in-chief.

10. § The editor-in-chief is elected by IMS members for three-month terms through secret, single winner ranked-choice voting. The election is organized by an IMS member outside our Department. Any Department member may stand in the election. Candidates must answer three standard questions from the election organizer. IMS members may ask individual questions to candidates; answering these is optional. The discussion and voting phases last at least 72 hours each.

11. § Elections for subdepartment coordinators or the editor-in-chief are triggered before the end of their term if

- (1) at least three Department members propose so,
- (2) such special election has not taken place within the past four weeks, and
- (3) a majority vote of the Department with a quorum of 40% supports doing so.

VII Deciding policy and direction

12. § The Department is responsible for creating and maintaining its policies, including editorial standards, peer review regulations, staff activity requirements, and relationships with other departments. Policies are public.

13. § Every decision not delegated to a person or group shall be decided through a simple majority vote with a quorum of 40% of Department members. The general direction of the Department is similarly decided.

VIII Amending the Constitution

14. § Any Department member may propose an amendment to this Constitution. If another member seconds it, a committee consisting of interested members formalizes the proposal, which is adopted through a majority vote of all members.

15. § This Constitution may also be amended through a unanimous vote of all Department members.

IX Ratification

This Constitution is adopted by members of the Institute of Minecraft Studies Publishing Department on August 7th, 2026.

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